ABOUT THE CURRICULUM

In today's times, many educational reforms are taking place. ICT is one of them. ICT stands for Information and Communication Technology. It is defined as the application of technology in the processing of information and communication, which includes the use of computers and software to not only convert and store data but also process, transmit, and retrieve it.

Since the world is moving technologically, ICT supports the teaching and learning process across all subjects by providing a wide range of resources while preparing learners for the modern workplace. It also prepares learners for programmes like Computer Science, Cyber Security, Computer Programming, and other IT-related careers.

ICT not only contributes to the development of critical thinking, creativity, invention and innovation of the learners, but also to practical performance and functional application of knowledge and skills. ICT helps the learner to apply knowledge and skills to provide individual and community needs and solve problems in everyday life.

ICT is one of the economic development pillars to gain national competitive advantage. It can improve the quality of human life because it can be used as a great learning and education media. It provides wider knowledge and can help in gaining and accessing information.

The significant role ICT can play in a student's learning process has also been highlighted in the National Curriculum Framework 2005 (NCF) as well as in New Education Policy 2020.

I believe it's crucial to continually update a curriculum with the goal of providing students with the necessary skills and knowledge to succeed in the modern world. This may include an emphasis on digital literacy, information technology, and communication skills, as well as critical thinking and problem-solving abilities.

With the rapid pace of technological advancements, it is essential that the ICT curriculum also stays up-to-date and relevant to prepare students for the digital world they will inhabit. A well-designed ICT curriculum should not only teach students the technical skills required to use technology, but also help them understand its impact on society and how it can be used to solve real-world problems.

Against this backdrop, we have revised the existing ICT Curriculum to ensure that students are equipped with the skills and knowledge they need to thrive in the 21st century. This updated curriculum will also assist the teachers of ICT in shaping the learning experiences and performances to accommodate everyone's needs and interests. This curriculum will tremendously help them achieve their goals. This curriculum also encourages students to use ICT ethically so that they can learn to use ICT responsibly and be aware of potential dangers and issues that can arise in the contemporary world. This curriculum takes care of the requirements of a 21st century learner with the following special features:

- Development of Life Skills like creative thinking, critical thinking, problem solving, interpersonal relationships, communication skills, collaboration

- Integration with real life scenarios
- Integration with other academic subjects (interdisciplinary approach)
- Inculcation of Values & Ethics
- Inclusivity: Gender Sensitization & Inclusion of the differently able

The key change in the curriculum is a move from a knowledge-based curriculum to a competence and skills based curriculum. This curriculum will serve as the foundation for the technology based vocational courses that may be delivered for class 9 to 12 or for further learning into core computer science.

I hope this curriculum will help the learners stay up-to-date with the latest trends and advancements in technology. This will also provide you with valuable insights and practical tips that you can apply in your daily life.

I would like to sincerely thank all the authors, editors and reviewers for putting in their best efforts towards shaping this curriculum. Their efforts are invaluable towards having this curriculum implemented in the schools and for improved quality of education in Delhi.

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